Sky Adventures Hub — User Manual

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1 Getting started

The Sky Adventures Hub is the web portal where Sky Adventures Aviation Club LLC (SAAC) runs training: syllabus sign-offs, logbooks, exams, study material and member records. It works in any browser on a phone, tablet or computer, so nothing needs installing.

Address: https://sky-adventures-portal-production.up.railway.app

Who uses it

Role	What they do
Student	Trains toward a rating: follows the training folio, logs flights, writes exams, reads study notes
Pilot / club member	Keeps a profile, licence details and logbook
Instructor	Signs off exercises and countersigns logbook entries for students
Chief Flight Instructor (CFI)	Runs the school: students, instructors, syllabus, exams, study material, settings
Admin (Office Manager)	Approves applications, manages student and pilot records, handles password resets

Signing up

1. Open the address above and choose **Sign up**.
2. Choose **New Student** or **Licensed Pilot / Club Member**.
3. Fill in your details. Required: first name, surname, ID or passport number, date of birth, email, cell number, next-of-kin name and number, and a password.
4. Upload a copy of your ID or passport (PDF, JPG or PNG). A profile picture and signature are optional.
5. Pilots also upload their current CAA licence and give its expiry date.
6. Sign the consent and indemnity declarations and submit.

Your application then waits for an instructor or admin to approve it. You can log in once it is approved. If WhatsApp is connected, you receive a message when that happens.

Signing in

Use your email and password on the login page. You land on your own home page automatically. Students and pilots who were added directly by the CFI must sign their consent and indemnity forms the first time they log in, before anything else opens.

Forgot your password

Choose **Forgot your password?** on the login page and enter your email. When email sending is set up, you receive a reset link that works for one hour and only once. If email is not set up yet, your request goes to the **Password resets** list, and an admin or the CFI sets a new password with you.

Invited by WhatsApp

The CFI can invite you by WhatsApp. Open the link in the message, set your password, and your account is created.

2 Students

Students train through the Hub from sign-up to rating. The top menu has five pages.

Menu	What it is
My Portfolio	Your home page: Club No., expiry, call sign, exam status, flight totals, links to your profile
Training folio	The syllabus for your training type, section by section
Logbook	Every flight you log, countersigned by your instructor
Forms & procedures	Documents the club wants you to have
Study Notes	Notes, slide decks and videos from your instructor

Training folio

Only the training you signed up for is shown (PG, PPG or PPT), in order: Phase 1, Phase 2, Phase 3, then Conversion and Practical Theory. Each exercise is **Not started**, **In progress** or **Signed off**. Your instructor signs exercises off. Every exercise in a section must be

signed off before the next section opens.

Logbook

1. Open **Logbook** and add a flight: date, type (PG, PPG, PPT or Winching), duration and launches, the instructor who flew with you, and the exercises covered.
2. The entry shows as pending until your instructor verifies and countersigns it.
3. If something is wrong, ask your instructor to edit the entry. Students cannot edit a countersigned entry themselves.

Your portfolio shows your totals for flights, flight time and launches.

Exams

Exams are listed on **My Portfolio**. There are two ways to write one:

- **Online:** open the exam and answer the questions. When you submit, it waits for review by your CFI or admin, who verifies the result.
- **Paper:** download or write the paper exam, then upload a scan or photo (PDF or image, up to 10 MB). Your CFI or admin marks it passed or failed.

The radio (RT) exam also accepts a copy of your radio licence and its number. If you fail, the exam may have a waiting period before you can retry; the exam card shows when.

Your CFI can also upload a paper exam for you from your folio and record the result.

Study notes

Open **Study Notes** to download files or follow links your instructor added. A message such as "your instructor will add them here" means nothing has been added yet.

Profile and documents

Click your name at the top right to edit your profile: contact details, picture and address. Your name, ID or passport number, email, call sign, training type and Club No. are set by your CFI, so ask them if one needs correcting.

- **View profile** shows your record; **Print portfolio** makes a printable copy.
- Upload your proof of payment on your profile. If you have not paid, the office will contact you. You can ask for an invoice with one click.
- The medical declaration can be completed online if you are under 60, or by uploading a signed GCAA medical form.
- Consent and indemnity must be signed before you can use the Hub.

3 Pilots and club members

Licensed pilots use the Hub as a personal record. The top menu has three pages: **My Portfolio**, **Logbook** and **Forms & procedures**.

- **My Portfolio:** your account details, GCAA No., Club No. and expiry, your licence and its expiry date, and the ratings and endorsements you hold.
- **Endorsements:** you declare the ratings you hold. Your CFI or admin confirms them when they review your application and logbook. A declined endorsement shows on your portfolio with the reason, and you can re-apply.
- **Licence renewal:** upload your renewed CAA licence and the new expiry date from your portfolio. It goes to the admin or CFI to approve.
- **Logbook:** log flights the same way students do. A pilot's entry is signed automatically when you save it, so no instructor countersign is needed.
- **Profile:** click your name to update contact details and documents.

The ratings ladder is being replaced with the UAE and GCAA equivalent. Until that is done, the labels on the ladder still follow the South African structure and should be ignored.

4 Instructors

An instructor signs off training and countersigns flights. Only the CFI manages students, other instructors, the syllabus and settings. The top menu has **Students** and **My Portfolio** (your own pilot record).

The student list

Students lists every active student with their progress (for example 0/25 exercises), Club No., expiry date and the status of each exam. Names are sorted A to Z. Click a name to open that student's folio.

On a student's folio

- **Exercises:** tick an exercise to sign it off. The student's next section opens when every exercise in the current one is signed off.
- **Logbook:** each flight the student logged waits for you. Verify it to countersign it. You can correct an entry or delete a wrong one.
- **Exams:** every exam shows its status. **Review & verify** opens a submitted exam.

Reviewing an exam

Open **Review & verify** on a submitted exam. For a paper exam you can **View what was submitted** or **Download** it. The file saves as "Student name - Exam title". Then choose **Mark passed** or **Mark failed**. You can also upload a new file or delete the upload.

Uploading a paper exam for a student

Use this when a student wrote on paper and did not upload it.

1. Open the student's folio and find the exam card.
2. Click **Upload paper exam**. After a fail the button reads **Upload retake (paper)**.
3. Choose the scan or photo (PDF or image, up to 10 MB). For the radio exam you can add the licence number.
4. Choose the result: **Mark later**, **Passed** or **Failed**. Passed or Failed is recorded straight away under your name.
5. Click **Upload**.

The button is not shown while a submission is waiting for review, after a pass, or if the student has already answered questions online.

5 Chief Flight Instructor (CFI)

The CFI can do everything an instructor does, and also runs the school. The CFI menu has these pages:

Menu	What it does
Students	The active student list and each student's folio
My Portfolio	The CFI's own pilot record
Add student	Creates a student account directly
Student profiles	Every student's record, documents and details
Instructors	Adds and manages instructors
Manage syllabus	Sections and exercises for each training type
Exam content	Creates and edits exams and their questions
Study material	Notes, slide decks, videos and links for students
Forms & procedures	Documents shared with students and pilots
Verification queue	New applications waiting for approval

Menu	What it does
Pilots	Pilot records, endorsements and licence renewals
Password resets	Requests waiting for a new password
Settings	Banner message, radio call, content export and import

A red number on a menu item means something is waiting for you.

Adding a student

1. Click **Add student** and fill in the details, including the training type (PG, PPG or PPT).
2. The student must sign their consent and indemnity forms the first time they log in.
3. Send an invite. With WhatsApp connected, the **Invite student via WhatsApp** button on the student list sends the link. A student can also use the invite link directly.

Only the CFI can change a student's name, ID or passport number, email, call sign, training type and Club No. On a student's page you can edit the call sign, toggle endorsements, archive the student or delete the account.

Instructors

Under **Instructors**, add an instructor. They receive an invite and set their own password. Regular instructors can sign off exercises and countersign logbooks, but cannot manage students, other instructors, the syllabus or settings.

Syllabus

Under **Manage syllabus**, each section has a training type (PG, PPG, PPT or all) and a phase. Students only see their own sections, in order: Phase 1, 2, 3, then Conversion and Practical Theory. A section opens only when the one before it is signed off. New exercises get a suggested code.

Exams

Under **Exam content**, create an exam, add its questions and set the rules, including any waiting period before a retry. You can also review submitted exams and mark paper exams (see section 4).

Study material and forms

Study material holds files and links that students see under Study Notes. **Forms & procedures** holds documents for students and pilots. Files can be up to 60 MB.

Settings

- **Banner:** one orange line shown under the header on every student page. Add a message and, if you like, a button linking to a document or web address.
- **Radio call:** the call every student is taught.
- **Content export and import:** downloads the syllabus, exams, study material and forms as a zip. Use it as a backup or to set up another hub. Import only works on an empty hub, and it never includes people or their personal documents.

6 Admin (Office Manager)

Admin looks after the paperwork and accounts. The menu has **Verification queue**, **Students**, **Pilots**, **Forms & procedures** and **Password resets**. A CFI who also holds admin rights sees the same pages plus a link back to the Instructor Portal.

Verification queue

New sign-ups wait here, oldest first. Open an application to review the details, the ID or passport copy, the signatures and the licence for pilots. **Approve** it, or **Reject** it with a reason. When you approve, the applicant gets a WhatsApp message if WhatsApp is connected. If it is not, a banner tells you to let them know yourself.

Students and pilots

- **Students:** every student record, sorted A to Z. Open one to see personal details, documents (ID, picture, proof of payment, medical) and training information. Each document has **View** and **Download**; the download is named "Name - Document".
- **Pilots:** pilot and club-member records. Review their endorsements and approve licence renewals; the number beside the menu item counts what is waiting.
- **Print:** an applicant's record can be printed from their page.

Password resets

When email is not working, a member's forgot-password request appears here. Set a new password with them, then the request is cleared.

Forms and procedures

Upload the documents students and pilots should see, such as club forms and procedures. They appear on the **Forms & procedures** page of each role.

7 WhatsApp and email

The Hub can send WhatsApp messages for invites and approvals, and emails for password resets. Both are optional. Without them the Hub still works, but people must be told in person.

WhatsApp (Green-API)

WhatsApp goes through Green-API. The CFI's WhatsApp number is linked to a Sky Adventures instance, so messages come from that number.

1. In the Green-API console, create an instance for Sky Adventures.
2. Link the sending number: WhatsApp, Settings, Linked devices, Link a device.
3. When the instance shows **Authorized**, copy its three values.
4. In Railway, open the Sky Adventures service, then Variables, and add `GREEN_API_URL`, `GREEN_API_ID_INSTANCE` and `GREEN_API_TOKEN_INSTANCE`.
5. Redeploy. The yellow "WhatsApp isn't connected" banner disappears.

Use a separate instance and number for Sky Adventures. Never share one with another system.

Inviting a student

On the student list, click **Invite student via WhatsApp**, enter their name and cell number, and send. The student opens the link, sets a password and is in. Their name drops off the open-invites list when they sign up with that number. If a send fails, the reason shows in the list and you can **Re-invite**.

Email

Password-reset emails need `RESEND_API_KEY` and `EMAIL_FROM` set in Railway. Until then, reset requests go to the Password resets list.

8 Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
I cannot log in after signing up	Your application must be approved first. Ask an instructor or admin to check the Verification queue.

Problem	What to do
I forgot my password	Use Forgot your password? on the login page. If no email arrives, ask the CFI or admin to reset it.
A reset link says it has expired	Links work once and for one hour. Request a new one.
The next syllabus section is locked	Every exercise in the section before it must be signed off by an instructor.
My logbook entry shows pending	An instructor must verify and countersign it. Remind them.
I cannot correct my name, ID number or call sign	Only the CFI can change these. Ask the CFI.
An exam upload fails	Use a PDF or photo of 10 MB or less.
Saving a very large study file fails	Files up to 60 MB are supported. Try again with a smaller file.
The page says something went wrong	Refresh the page. If it repeats, sign out and back in, then tell the CFI the time and what you were doing.
WhatsApp is not connected	Set the three Green-API values in Railway (section 7).
I do not see Upload paper exam	The exam is awaiting review, already passed, or the student answered online. Review or delete that attempt first.

When reporting a problem, note the date and time and the build number shown under the header, for example "deployed 09 Oct 2026, 13:23 · 0c0f25d".

9 Change log

Date	Batch	What changed for users
9 Oct 2026	3	Saving files over 10 MB no longer fails. Download buttons on submitted exams and every profile document. The CFI or an instructor can upload a paper exam for a student and mark it. Student, student-profile and pilot lists are sorted A to Z.

Date	Batch	What changed for users
7 Oct 2026	2 (live)	The Hub went live on Railway with six demo accounts.
6 Oct 2026	2	Sky Adventures logo, blue and orange colours and favicon. Wording moved to GCAA, Club No. and Member No. UAE data-protection wording on sign-up.
5 Oct 2026	1	First version: first-run setup, starter syllabus and exams, content export and import.

Still to come: SAAC and GCAA forms, the approved syllabus and exam questions, and the UAE ratings ladder. Some exam names and forms still use South African wording until then.